

FRED ZIRBEL

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EXPERIENCE

Critical Start

Plano, TX

Principal Security Analyst

July 2026 – Present

- Investigate and respond to phishing, malware, and identity-based intrusions across 2,500+ multi-tenant environments in a Managed Detection and Response (MDR) operation, triaging alerts ingested from 30+ integrated security products.
- Maintain a 16-minute average time to investigation (TTI) while working 300+ alerts monthly.
- Execute remediation actions on live incidents, including host isolations, credential resets, session revocations, email deletions, and file quarantines, within a dual-authorization workflow.
- Communicate directly with customer stakeholders during high-priority incidents to convey impact, remediation status, and response decisions.
- Train and mentor L1 analysts on investigation workflows and escalation quality.

Senior Security Analyst

July 2025 – July 2026

- Performed log and endpoint-telemetry analysis with custom KQL, correlating URL clicks, file downloads, identity activity, and process telemetry to establish root cause and reconstruct attacker actions.
- Seconded and verified remediation actions initiated by principal analysts, confirming scope, target accuracy, and justification before execution.
- Briefed customer stakeholders in 3 to 5 weekly high-priority incident calls, delivering evidence-backed findings, attribution, and remediation guidance.
- Detected and correlated cross-tenant phishing and malware campaigns from shared indicators, escalating campaign-level findings for coordinated, multi-customer response.
- Engineered 500+ suppression filters (KVP logic + regex), eliminating thousands of recurring false-positive alerts.
- Validated 5+ suppression and orchestration changes daily, serving as the team's pre-deployment quality gate.

Security Analyst

October 2024 – July 2025

- Triaged and investigated identity threats, phishing, malware, and endpoint alerts across a large client base using Microsoft Defender, Sentinel, CrowdStrike, and SentinelOne.
- Developed custom KQL queries in Microsoft Sentinel and Defender to scope incidents across identity, endpoint, and email telemetry.
- Produced client-ready escalations with accurate attribution, investigation context, and remediation guidance, supporting senior-led customer communications.

TOOLS & TECHNICAL SKILLS

EDR/XDR: Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, CrowdStrike Falcon, Palo Alto Cortex XDR, SentinelOne

SIEM & Log Analysis: Microsoft Sentinel, Splunk Enterprise Security, Sumo Logic, KQL

Identity & Cloud: Azure, Microsoft Entra ID, identity telemetry, Windows endpoint telemetry

Incident Response & Detection: Incident investigation & response, alert triage, scope & impact analysis, root-cause analysis, remediation & containment execution, evidence-backed escalation, phishing / malware / identity-threat response, cross-tenant campaign correlation, detection tuning & suppression engineering

Frameworks: MITRE ATT&CK, NIST SP 800-61

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA SecurityX (CASP+), CompTIA CySA+, CompTIA PenTest+, CompTIA Security+, ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)

EDUCATION

Western Governors University

January 2024 – December 2025

Master of Science in Cybersecurity and Information Assurance

Remote

The University of Texas at Arlington

August 2019 – December 2023

Bachelor of Science in Information Systems

Arlington, TX